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Microsoft is buying tons of carbon removal from Xprize startup Vaulted Deep



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- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

Investing heavily in renewable power — avoiding emissions is considered the appropriate first step — there are some things it must use, like semiconductors, for which there are no zero-greenhouse-gas alternatives.

Last year, Microsoft generated 14.9 million metric tons' worth of greenhouse gas emissions, it said, more than double what it hopes to be producing in 2030, when it plans on reaching negative carbon emissions.

To hit its ramping Among Chestn southea tons with operatio

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prices rise on August 7.

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Topics: [carbon credits](#) [carbon removal](#) [Climate](#)



Tim De Chant

Senior Reporter, Climate | [X](#) [Twitter](#) [in](#)

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Tim De Chant — 4:30 AM PST · February 12, 2025

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Nature-based carbon removal startup Chestnut Carbon has raised \$160 million in Series B financing, the company told TechCrunch. The startup buys marginal and degraded farmland, plants them with native trees, and harvests the resulting carbon credits.

Carbon credits have become a hot commodity, especially among tech companies looking to offset skyrocketing emissions caused in part by the



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carbon credit capacity to 100 million metric tons by 2030, which will require hundreds of thousands of acres to be transformed back into forests.

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Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

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reforestation hold great potential to rein in the effects of climate warming pollution.

A [study in 2019](#) found that the world can support 2.2 billion acres more forest than it has today. Once those forests matured, they would hold 205 billion metric tons of carbon, or about a quarter of the carbon currently in the atmosphere.

Topics: [Canada Pension Plan Investment Board](#)



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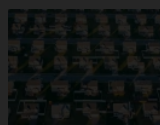
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To trim that number, Microsoft has been buying large amounts of renewable power and, to tackle what it can't replace with renewables, it has been inking deals that remove carbon dioxide from the atmosphere, helping to offset what it can't eliminate.

CLIMATE



This Detroit startup is turning to utilities to make home efficiency upgrades cheaper

Tim De Chant - Aug 1, 2025

The Microsoft project is the first of a dozen that CO280 has in the works, co-founder and CEO Jonathan Rhone exclusively told TechCrunch. Rhone, who used to sell power plants to the pulp and paper industry, said that adding carbon capture to the process seemed like a natural fit.

“It just seemed like a no-brainer that everyone had missed,” he said. The pulp and paper industry release carbon

To build working SLB (for Carbon on the v attache which h The boi locked



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Normally, the wood-locked carbon would be dumped into the atmosphere. But by drawing CO₂ from this step in the process, the paper mill will be effectively removing carbon from the atmosphere by way of photosynthesis. “The trees do all the heavy lifting by capturing CO₂ from the atmosphere,” Rhone said.

Once captured, the carbon dioxide will be sent 40 miles via pipeline to a saline aquifer that is being



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Tim De Chant

Senior Reporter, Climate |

Tim De Chant is a senior climate reporter at TechCrunch. He has written for a wide range of publications, including...



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Earlier this week, [ExxonMobil](#), a company among the largest producers of greenhouse gas emissions and a longtime leader in the corporate fight against climate change regulations, called for a massive \$100 billion project (backed in part by the government) to sequester hundreds of millions of metric tons of carbon dioxide in geologic formations off the Gulf of Mexico.

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The gall of Exxon's flag planting request is matched only by the grit from startup companies that are already working on carbon capture and storage or carbon utilization projects and have announced significant milestones along their own path to commercialization even as Exxon was asking for handouts.

These are companies like [Charm Industrial](#), which just completed the first pilot test of its technology



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1/ Today we're announcing we've delivered [@stripe's](#) 416 ton CO₂e carbon removal purchase ahead of schedule, just 12 months after inventing our new carbon removal pathway. The carbon is now in permanent geological storage.

<https://t.co/Zly2plK6n9>

— Charm Industrial (@CharmIndustrial) [April 20, 2021](#)

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executive Rob Niven. “We look at CO2 as a value-added input into making concrete production. It has to raise profits.”

Niven stresses that CarbonCure, which recently won one half of the \$20 million carbon capture XPrize alongside CarbonBuilt, is not a hypothetical solution for carbon dioxide removal. The company already has 330 plants operating around the world

capturing carbon dioxide emissions and sequestering them in building materials.

Applications for carbon utilization are important to reduce the emissions footprints of industry, but for nations to achieve their climate objectives, the world needs to move to dramatically reduce its reliance on emissions spewing energy sources and simultaneously permanently draw down massive amounts of greenhouse gases that are already in the atm

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country's total industrial and power generation emissions). But in ExxonMobil's calculation that's a reason to continue with business-as-usual (actually with more government subsidies for its business).

Here's how the company's top executives explained it in the pages of [The Wall Street Journal](#):



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The Houston CCS Innovation Zone concept would require the “whole of government” approach to the climate challenge that President Biden has championed. Based on our experience with projects of this scale, we estimate the approach could generate tens of thousands of new jobs needed to make and install the equipment to capture the CO2 and transport it via a pipeline for storage. Such a project would also protect thousands of existing jobs in industries seeking to



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ExxonMobil is expected to play a role to play in the new energy economy that's being built worldwide, but the leading American oil companies are not going to be able to rest on their laurels or continue operating with a business-as-usual mindset. These companies run the risk of going the way of big coal — slowly sliding into obsolescence and potentially taking thousands of jobs and local economies down with them.

To avoid that, carbon sequestration is a part of the solution, but it's one of many arrows in the quiver that oil companies need to deploy if they're going to continue operating and adding value to shareholders. In other words, it's not the last 130 years of emissions that ExxonMobil should be focused on, it's the next 130 years that aim to be increasingly zero-emission.



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